Video Jockey Case Study — Supplementary Reading

This document is supplementary reading for the Basic Workshop v2.0.

The complete Video Jockey case study—a detailed walkthrough of cross-platform feature development over 4 sessions with Claude Code—is maintained in the v1 workshop materials:

Full Case Study: `./video-jockey-case-study.pdf`

Why This Case Study Matters

This case study documents a **real feature development cycle** (January 2026) showing how agentic AI works in practice:

- **4 active sessions** over 4 weeks
- **~20 hours hands-on time** (vs. estimated ~120 hours solo)
- **25 context overflows** managed via file-based state
- **Zero F5 debugging** — log-based analysis instead
- Architecture documentation, test harness, and tribal knowledge all emerged naturally from the workflow

---

The 7 Key Patterns

#	Pattern	Session	Key Insight
1	**Planning as Product**	1	43 minutes of planning before any code. Deep exploration of codebase structure, then propose changes.
2	**Guardrails in Action**	4	Agent got hasty; human said "slow down." Agent responded with structured table-based analysis.
3	**Context Management**	4	25 context overflows. Solution: file-based state (workflow.md) survives; conversation doesn't.
4	**Testing with Human Intervention**	4	Human runs tests, agent analyzes logs. Division of labor: judgment vs. pattern recognition.
5	**Learning → Documentation**	4	Convert progress tracking into timeless reference docs. Docs are forever; session notes are ephemeral.
6	**Subagent Usage**	2–4	Delegate audits, builds, log analysis, code searches to subagents. Main agent stays on design.
7	**When the Agent Struggles**	3–4	P-frame debugging took iterations. Adding diagnostic logging was the breakthrough.

Why It Was Moved to Supplementary Reading

The case study was previously in the Basic Workshop slide deck (v1.3). For v2.0, it has been **removed from the presentation** and moved here based on feedback:

- **Too detailed for workshop pacing** — 12 slides of deep technical walkthrough interrupted the narrative flow
- **Better as reference material** — Audiences can study at their own pace without blocking the main workshop story
- **Supports the "Honesty Standard"** — The case study is the primary evidence backing workshop claims about agentic AI workflow

---

How to Use This Reading

1. **After the workshop:** Read the full case study to see patterns in action
2. **When planning your own agentic AI project:** Reference the 7 patterns as guardrails
3. **For documentation:** Study Pattern 5 (learning extraction) as a model for turning debugging sessions into maintainable docs

---

Case study extracted from Claude Code JSONL transcripts (January–February 2026)